



The Indian Rocks

The [Indian Rocks](#), located in Smiths Ferry across the river from [Georgetown](#), were landmarks until dredging operations for the Stratton Dam at New Cumberland, WV, resulted in deeply burying the rocks, presumably never to be uncovered. Opened for traffic in Nov 1959, the Stratton Dam also increased the water level of the river by approximately ten feet. If the [petroglyphs](#) are not buried, the water level will probably never again be low enough to see the rocks.



Indian Pictographs at Smith's Ferry Postcard dated 1908 (Anna L and John F Nash Collection)

Before the dam was erected, the Ohio River was known to dry up at Smiths Ferry during the summer season and people traveled by horse and buggy from as far as Pittsburgh, crossing over the dry river bed, to view the historical Indian site. Pictures of Smiths Ferry's [Indian Rocks](#) have been

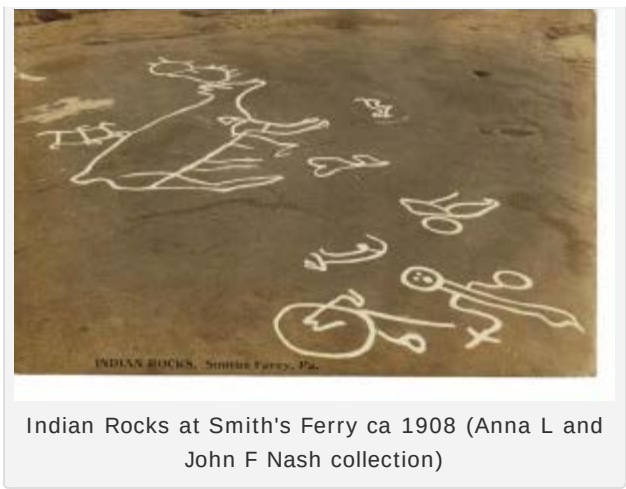
printed in the National Geographic and in Bausman's History of Beaver County.

These images are real photo postcards (RPPCs) dated 1908. To photograph the [petroglyphs](#), white chalk was placed into the carved depressions and the photos were often taken from ladders.

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- » [Site Introduction](#)
- » [Site Rules](#)
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- » [No Place for a Lady](#)
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- » [NPE Journal Segment 2](#)
- » [It Used To Be A River Town](#)
- » [History in Homes](#)
 - » [The Lost Frontier Fort](#)
 - » [The Indian Fighters](#)
- » [The Circuit Rider](#)
- » [The Body](#)
- » [The Mercy Mission](#)
- » [The Ride](#)
- » [The Preacher's Note](#)
- » [The Game](#)
- » [The Point of Beginning](#)
- » [The Indian Rocks](#)
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 - » [Capt Jacob Poe](#)
 - » [Capt Adam W Poe](#)
 - » [River Experiences](#)
 - » [Index of Names](#)
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Indian Rocks at Smith's Ferry ca 1908 (Anna L and John F Nash collection)

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 - » [The Case for Indemnity](#)
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 - » [Str Horizon](#)
 - » [The Case for Indemnity](#)
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- » [Catalogue of Deeds](#)
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- » [Lots 19&20 1850](#)
- » [Lot 21 1804](#)
- » [Lot 21 1850](#)
- » [Poe Wood 1850](#)
- » [Map 17 Dec 1847](#)
- » [Map 1876](#)
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- » [Ltr WH Turner](#)
- » [Ltrs Jacob Poe](#)
- » [Ltrs William A Calhoon](#)
- » [Ltr Adam Poe 22 Mar 1849](#)
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- » [St Luke's Episcopal Church](#)
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- » [Georgetown Cemetery File](#)
- » [Steamboating Poe Ancestry](#)
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- » [Recommended Reading List](#)
- » [Acknowledgements](#)

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